Jaime Polanco-Jimenez

Ph.D. in Economics, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana & KU Leuven

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Research Interests

Human Capital Development, Organizational Behavior, Managerial Decision-Making, Applied Microeconomics, and Economics of Education.

Education

KU Leuven — **Aug 2020 – March 2026**
Ph.D. in Economics (Joint Degree) — *Leuven, Belgium*

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana — **Aug 2020 – May 2026**
Ph.D. in Economics (Joint Degree) — *Bogota, Colombia*

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana — **Nov 2024**
M.S. in Economics — *Bogota, Colombia*

Udmurt State University — **Sep 2018 – Jul 2020**
M.S. in Economics — *Izhevsk, Russia*

Udmurt State University — **Sep 2017 – Jul 2019**
M.S. in Oil and Gas Engineering — *Izhevsk, Russia*

University of America — **2016**
Bachelor in Oil and Gas Engineering — *Bogota, Colombia*

Publications

- **(Job Market Paper)** Polanco-Jimenez, J. & De Witte, K. (2025). *The Tailoring Premium: AI Design, Behavioral Engagement, and Human Capital Formation.* Accepted at *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization.* [Tracking Link]
- Polanco-Jimenez, J. (2025). *Road to the Future: Identifying Impacts of Roads on Education in Colombia. International Journal of Educational Development*, 114, 103173.
- Polanco-Jimenez, J. & De Witte, K. (2025). *Factors Influencing STEM Participation and Effective Intervention Strategies.* European Commission, Directorate-General for Education, Youth, Sport and Culture / NESET Report, Publications Office of the European Union. [EU Publications] [DOI]
- **(Book Chapter)** Castañeda, B. & Polanco-Jimenez, J. (2026). Decisiones educativas de los jóvenes en tiempos de transición. In A. Álvarez, J. Guerra-España, & M. Hofstetter (Eds.), *Retos económicos de la transición energética en Colombia* (pp. 125–142). Ediciones Uniandes. [DOI] [Book Link]

Working Papers and Books

- Polanco-Jimenez, J., De Witte, K., & Bernal, G. L. (2025). *Does Coeducation Close the STEM Gap? Evidence from a Single-Sex Schooling Transition in Colombia.* Under Peer-Review at *Journal of Development Economics.*
- Lozano, J. & Polanco-Jimenez, J. (2025). *Financial Literacy and Business Success: Evidence from an RCT in Colombia.*
- Polanco-Jimenez, J., & Posso, C. (2025). *Black Gold and Dull Minds: The Impact of Oil Exploration Announcements on Education in Colombia.*
- Polanco-Jimenez, J., De Witte, K., & François, M. (2026). *Heterogeneous Effects of Persona Design on the Educational Aspirations.*
- Polanco-Jimenez, J., Sevilla, A., & Vicente, I. (2026). *Complementarity Between Expertise and Tasks: Evidence from a Purpose-Built AI System.*
- Polanco-Jimenez, J. & Montero-Mestre, J. L. (2026). *Drilling into the Forest: How Exploration Announcements Reshape Land and Crops in Colombia.*
- **(Book)** Polanco-Jimenez, J. & De Witte, K. (2026). *The Algorithmic Ladder: RCTs, Artificial Intelligence, and the Future of Human Capital — A Comprehensive Framework for Policy-Relevant Science.* Under review, Leuven University Press.

Academic and Research Experience

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana **Jul 2026 – Dec 2026**
Professor of Statistics *Bogota, Colombia*

London School of Economics and Political Science **Since March 2026**
Visiting Fellow at WISPPRH

KU Leuven – LEER, Belgium **Since March 2026**
Associate Researcher

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana **Oct 2022 – 2024**
Graduate Teaching Assistant – Advanced Econometrics I & II *Instructor: Adrian Garlati*

Banco de la República, Colombia **Aug 2022 – Mar 2023**
Research Assistant *Joint research on macroeconomic shocks and human capital.*

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana **Oct 2020 – Aug 2021**
Research Assistant *Laboratorio Economía de la Educación (LEE)*

Bogotá Summer School in Economics **2021**
Graduate Teaching Assistant *Real Analysis (Instructor: Andres Carvajal)*

Extension and Professional Services

Servinformación **Oct 2022 - Current**
Consultant – Senior Data Scientist *Bogotá, Colombia*

Fiscal Observatory, Universidad Javeriana **Aug 2023 – Dec 2023**
Consultant *Policy and fiscal analyses.*

Secretaría de Salud de Bogotá **Oct 2020 – Aug 2022**
Data Scientist *Analytical support during public health operations.*

RCT Registrations + Ongoing Projects

- Polanco-Jimenez, J. & Sevilla, A. (2026). "Evaluating an AI-Powered Research Development Tool for Academic Productivity and Well-being." *AEA RCT Registry*. January 28. DOI
- Polanco-Jimenez, J. & De Witte, K. (2025). "A Randomized Controlled Trial of an AI-Based Guidance Tool for Post-Secondary Planning." *AEA RCT Registry*. DOI
- Polanco-Jimenez, J. & De Witte, K. (2024). "The Tailoring Premium: How AI Design Unlocks Student Engagement and Learning." *AEA RCT Registry*. DOI

Scholarships and Grants

- Google Cloud Platform Research Credits Program, 2024–2026. Awarded $5,000 USD.
- Doctoral Fellowship, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana, 2020. Merit-based full scholarship.
- Russian Government Scholarship, Udmurt State University, 2018. International grant.

Table 1: Technical Skills and Professional Certifications

Category	Details
Languages	Spanish (Native), English (Fluent), Russian (Fluent)
Programming	Python, R, Stata, SQL, LaTeX
Methodologies	Causal Inference (RCTs, DiD, RDD), Applied Econometrics, Machine Learning, Cloud Computing (GCP)
Certifications	Google Cloud Professional Machine Learning Engineer; Google Cloud Professional Data Engineer

Notes: Certifications verified by Google Cloud Professional program. Methodological expertise focuses on causal identification in human capital research.

References

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